BEFORE YOU RENOVATE. BEFORE YOU SELL.

The one-page decision checklist / Team Cyril, NGU Real Estate

Before paying for optional work, check the problem, the buyer case and the complete cost. A cleaner presentation does not guarantee a higher net sale result.

THE FOUR CALLS

Spend: consider modest preparation suited to the condition and budget.

Fix: investigate defects or compliance concerns with the right professional.

Ask first: assess the scope, costs, likely buyer and time before committing.

Skip for now: defer discretionary work unless property-specific evidence supports it.

WALK YOUR HOME WITH THESE QUESTIONS

[ ] Is this a defect, or simply an older finish? Diagnose before covering it.

[ ] Could cleaning, adjustment or a targeted repair be sufficient?

[ ] Have I compared recent settled sales of genuinely similar properties?

[ ] Do quotes include preparation, disposal, fees, contingency and delay costs?

[ ] Would the optional work still make sense if the extra proceeds are lower?

[ ] Have I started the smoke-alarm, pool and seller-disclosure conversations?

[ ] Have I agreed what to do, what to defer and who needs to advise?

STOP BEFORE DISTURBING OLDER MATERIALS

Never pressure-wash asbestos-containing materials. If the material is uncertain, get qualified advice before cleaning, sanding or drilling. This is a Queensland Government restriction, not just a presentation tip.

KEEP THE NEXT STEP SIMPLE

Use the online planner to download your selected jobs as a personal PDF. Include them with your request for a free pre-sale walkthrough and market appraisal.

Open the planner / Read the full 8-page guide and sources

General information only. No renovation return or sale outcome is guaranteed. A market appraisal is not a formal valuation. Sources and limits: full guide, page 8. Reviewed 26 October 2026.